Macintosh Mini

Setup guide

Your Mini is built and ready. Setting it up takes about ten minutes. You'll need your phone, your Wi-Fi password and a Mac ROM file (more on that below).

1 Turn it on

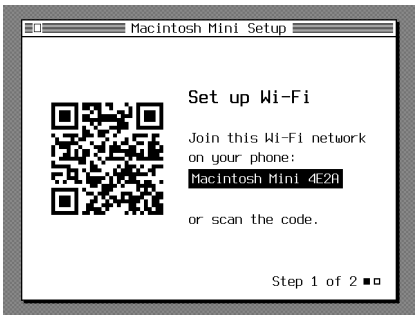
Push the floppy disk into its slot. After a moment, the screen shows **Set up Wi-Fi**.

2 Connect it to Wi-Fi

On your phone, join the Wi-Fi network shown on the screen: **Macintosh Mini** followed by four letters and numbers. You can also scan the code with your phone's camera.

A setup page opens. Choose your home Wi-Fi, type its password, and pick a password for the Mini. You'll only need that one for advanced things later. Then tap **Connect**.

If the page doesn't open, go to `10.42.0.1` in your phone's browser. If the screen says **Couldn't join**, check your Wi-Fi password and try again. The Mini needs 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi, which almost every home router has.

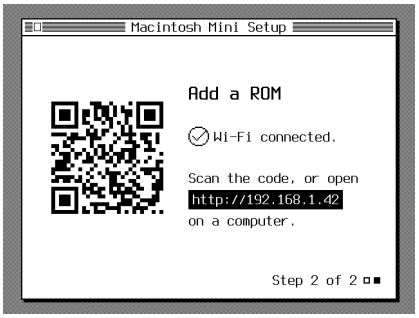


3 Add a ROM

Once it's on your Wi-Fi, the screen shows a code and an address. Scan the code with your phone, or type the address into a browser on your computer.

Upload your ROM file (a .zip is fine), or paste its download link. The Mini checks it and starts Mac OS. Listen for the chime!

If it comes back to this screen, that ROM didn't work. Reload the page and try another.



Your address will be different.

About the ROM

Every Mac needs a ROM: Apple's built-in startup code. It isn't included, because Apple still owns it.

Redundant Robot's emulator guide explains which one to use and where to find it. The **Performa ROM** works best. `redundantrobot.com/sheepshaver`

Everyday use

Turning it off. Press the right button, wait about 20 seconds, then pull out the floppy.

Restarting. Press the left button. It's also the fix if Mac OS ever freezes.

Brightness. Turn the dial. The screen also dims after sunset and turns off late at night. Turn the dial to wake it.

Charging. Plug in a USB-C cable. The Mini runs on its battery or plugged in.

New Wi-Fi. If you move, or change your Wi-Fi, hold the left button for 10 seconds and do step 2 again.

Keyboard and mouse. On its own, the Mini is a desk clock and screen saver. To use Mac OS, plug a USB keyboard and mouse into the port on the back, if yours has one.

What's on it

Mac OS 8.1, set up and ready. It has iCab and MR Browser for the web, and iCab opens a page of sites that still work on old Macs. After Dark's flying toasters appear after 5 minutes. There's also Big Maclock, a desk clock, plus StuffIt Expander and Disk Copy for old Mac downloads. It can print to an AppleTalk ImageWriter, like an AirWriter.

Going further

You don't need any of this day to day. Underneath Mac OS, the Mini runs Raspberry Pi OS. You can reach it from a computer on the same Wi-Fi.

Its name is `macintosh-mini-` plus the four letters and numbers from its Wi-Fi network, in lower case (like `macintosh-mini-4e2a`). The username is **mac**, and the password is the one you chose in step 2. If the name doesn't work, use the address from step 3.

Log in from Terminal, or PowerShell on Windows:

```
ssh mac@macintosh-mini-4e2a.local
```

Copy files with an app like Cyberduck or FileZilla. Choose SFTP (not FTP), and use the same name, username and password.

Use a different disk image by copying it into the home folder and deleting the old one, then pressing the left button. Disks with System 7.5 to Mac OS 8.1 work (.hda, .dsk, .img or .hfv). The original is at `archive.org/details/macos-8.1-basilisk-ii`.

Get updates by logging in and running:

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/wr/macintosh-mini/main/setup.sh | bash
```

Can't find it by name? Some routers block names ending in .local. Use its address, or look for `macintosh-mini` in your router's list of devices.

A soft hum on battery is normal for this board, and quieter with the brightness turned down.

Build guide and help
`wells.ee/projects/macintosh-mini`
Questions: `github.com/wr/macintosh-mini/issues`

Macintosh Mini by Wells Workshop
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